

Siddharth Bhaskaran

7660 Beverly Blvd. Apt 231, Los Angeles CA 90036 | (310) 343 9671 | siddharth99.ram@gmail.com

3/15/2026

To the MQE Admissions Team,

It was roughly 11 years ago, at the age of 15, that I was forced to begin my undergraduate education, and it wasn't something I had expected to have to do for years. I had just moved to the US from India a few months prior and was supposed to begin high school, but had just been told that because of equivalency issues, my options were to either repeat a year or leave with a high school diploma. It was in this context that I first reflected on why I wanted to pursue higher education in the first place—curiosity. Daunting as it may have been to study in a foreign country as a teenager in classrooms full of adults, my natural inquisitiveness carried me through the chaos of navigating college bureaucracy, culture shock, and my choice of major and eventual career. My compulsive need to understand every last detail of how the world worked forced me to contend with every hurdle I faced head-on, and because I left nothing unquestioned and sought to leave no question unanswered, I was motivated to learn the skills needed to find meaning from chaos.

As I entered my second year of college, my choice to major in economics was motivated by that very impulse; my coursework emphasized the statistical and mathematical tools that helped explain why the world works the way it does—precisely the skills I needed to make sense of the people and systems around me. Coursework like Econometrics and Game Theory gave me a framework for how to think about cause and effect, how to approach thinking about complex problems, and a way to know what questions need to be asked to get to a solution; all skills that continue to serve me in my professional life. I am now seen as someone who can both get to the root of a problem quickly and consider its broader implications. I have spearheaded meaningful strategic projects; even as a junior employee, I was trusted to work with company leadership to overhaul our pricing system, taking into account a number of quantitative and qualitative factors in coming up with a viable new approach to how we priced and grouped our product offerings, because I was seen as someone who could guide us to a defensible, data-driven outcome.

This strong strategic judgement that my colleagues have come to rely on is, therefore, an evolution of the very curiosity that first let me thrive in higher education as a lost teenager in a new home. I hope to bring both to the MQE's next cohort. The MQE's emphasis on building a scholastic community requires a class of diverse voices and keen intellectual curiosity. My experiences navigating an unconventional higher education experience without a clear path to guide me have forged me into someone with a unique perspective and strong judgement—and the curiosity that helped me get there is the same strength that makes me an invaluable addition to your program.

Thank you for your consideration.

Sincerely,

Siddharth Bhaskaran